Wendy's Opportunity Discussion

Improving x Cognition AI — Call Prep

June 8, 2026 | 2:00 PM CDT | 30 min | Partner meeting — existing relationship context, active deal

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Background / History

Benton Bagot — Manager, Strategic Partnerships, Cognition AI

Day-to-day partnerships operator at Cognition. Prior role: IBM, Data & AI / Watson Strategic Partnerships Specialist — built go-to-market commercial models and AI use case pipelines there. He understands the SI/consulting partner motion well. Has been point person on Cognition's formal partnerships with Infosys and Cognizant. Notable: he has publicly cited Improving's "mastery of Devin and Windsurf" and "methodology on scaling and governance" as key to AI success for organizations. He already views Improving as differentiated — use it.

Patton — Cognition AI (patton@cognition.ai)

Last name unknown. First-name-only cognition.ai email strongly suggests a founder or very early team member. Cognition's known co-founders: Scott Wu (CEO), Steven Hao, Walden Yan. "Patton" does not appear in public Cognition leadership documentation. Treat as likely a founder or senior leader with broad authority — may be joining to assess fit at a level above Benton. Prepare to be evaluated on vision and governance credibility, not just deal mechanics.

John Foley — Wendy's

Role not confirmed through public sources. Sync with Devlin before 2pm to confirm Foley's exact role and current standing within the Wendy's relationship. Knowing whether he is a champion, a gatekeeper, or a new stakeholder changes how much time to spend bringing him up to speed on Project Fresh context.

Company Overview

Cognition AI

San Francisco-based AI company founded August 2023 by Scott Wu, Steven Hao, and Walden Yan. Flagship product is Devin — an autonomous AI software engineering agent capable of end-to-end development tasks: writing, testing, debugging, and deploying code. Platform has expanded to include Windsurf IDE (acquired), Devin Wiki, and Devin Search.

May 2026: raised $1B at a $25B valuation (Lux Capital, General Catalyst, 8VC). $492M ARR, enterprise usage growing 50% MoM for six consecutive months. Enterprise customers include Mercedes-Benz, NASA, Goldman Sachs, and Santander. Formal SI partnerships already signed with Infosys and Cognizant — those are the structural comps for what Improving is being positioned into.

Competing on agent-first architecture vs. IDE-centric tools (GitHub Copilot, Cursor). The $1B raise signals aggressive investment in the partner/channel motion for enterprise deployment.

Wendy's

Major QSR chain, ~7,000 locations globally. **Project Fresh** is the company's $100M+ technology transformation running through 2026: POS modernization, data platform upgrades, AI-driven ordering (FreshAI), and digital infrastructure renewal including Atlassian consolidation. FreshAI is already processing tens of thousands of drive-thru orders daily and scaling to additional locations. 2026 digital/AI capex projected at $120M-$130M.

Currently in a CEO transition — Ken Cook serving as Interim CEO. Leadership transitions create both risk (program scope can shift) and opportunity (new leadership often accelerates visible digital wins). Project Fresh has enough organizational momentum to be largely independent of the CEO seat.

Improving's Position

Improving has an active delivery relationship inside Project Fresh. Cognition is not walking into a cold account — they're walking into an account where Improving is already delivering. That changes the risk calculus for everyone in the room. Skim the Wendy's account plan before 2pm to refresh on current engagement scope.

The play: co-sell Devin into Project Fresh alongside Improving's consulting delivery. Improving provides the delivery infrastructure, governance model, and client trust — Cognition provides the product. Infosys and Cognizant are the structural precedent. The central question is whether Improving lands as a formal SI partner or in a lighter commercial arrangement. That needs to get answered in this meeting.

Two critical unknowns to drive toward:

1. Commercial model — reseller, referral fee, co-sell revenue share, or co-branded delivery motion? Each has materially different implications for pipeline credit and economics. The Infosys/Cognizant structures are the baseline — understand what those look like before agreeing to anything.
2. Data governance for Devin on a client engagement — Wendy's has POS, loyalty, and operational data flowing through Project Fresh. Before Devin touches any of it, there must be a clear data boundary model. Improving should position itself as owning the governance definition as part of the delivery wrapper.

Relationship history: March 30 Convergence AI dinner with Jeff Wang / Cognition seeded this. May 5 Devlin alignment call on AI dev tools and Wendy's. This is the first live discussion with Wendy's in the room — it advances Rock 4 (Q2: $15M co-sell pipeline, at least one joint account play with documented strategy).

Proposed Agenda

Time	Topic
0:00-0:05	Introductions and context-setting — who's in the room, why this meeting now
0:05-0:12	Cognition frames the Devin opportunity — enterprise motion, SI partner model, Infosys/Cognizant as precedent
0:12-0:20	Improving and Wendy's frame Project Fresh — current engagement scope, where Devin fits in the roadmap
0:20-0:27	Commercial structure and governance — how the partnership is structured, data boundary model for client deploym
0:27-0:30	Next steps — who owns what, what needs to be documented before this advances

Talking Points

1. Improving is already inside Wendy's — this is an acceleration play, not a sourcing play.

Cognition's channel motion typically runs through SIs who bring accounts. Improving has the account. The conversation is about how to deploy Devin into a live engagement quickly, not how to identify a prospect.

That's a different and faster conversation.

2. Benton already called out Improving's governance methodology. Hold him to it.

He publicly cited Improving's "methodology on scaling and governance" as key to AI success. That framing opens the door to positioning Improving's delivery model as the governance layer that makes Devin safe to deploy at a regulated enterprise. Use that when discussing data governance on the Wendy's engagement.

3. The Infosys and Cognizant structures are the baseline — ask what they look like.

Cognition has formal SI partnerships with two of the largest consulting firms in the world. Improving needs to understand the commercial mechanics of those deals — reseller margin, referral rate, co-sell credit, or something else — before agreeing to any structure. Don't negotiate blind.

4. Wendy's is in a CEO transition — Project Fresh has momentum but needs a confirmed internal champion.

The transformation has organizational inertia, but leadership transitions create uncertainty. Understanding where John Foley sits — whether he's a Project Fresh champion or a new stakeholder — determines how to frame the Devin opportunity for Wendy's leadership.

5. Rock 4 is real and this is the first live candidate — name it.

David is carrying a Q2 commitment to build $15M in co-sell pipeline with at least one joint account play with a documented strategy. Wendy's + Cognition is that candidate. Being direct about it with Cognition signals seriousness and urgency — it's not a fishing expedition.

6. Data governance is the gating question for Wendy's, not technology.

Wendy's will not have a Devin conversation without a clear answer on what data it can access, what it cannot, and who is contractually responsible for enforcing those boundaries. Improving should offer to own that governance definition as part of the delivery wrapper. That's where Improving's value as an SI is clearest.